

Military Developments

The 1960s saw startlingly fast and effective fighters capable of flying at more than twice the speed of sound. In contrast, there were aircraft in supporting roles that had soldiered on reliably since the 1940s. Some of the 1960s fighters and bombers remain in frontline service worldwide, steadily updated and scheduled to serve until 2045 or beyond.



▽ **Boeing B-52 Stratofortress 1960**
Origin USA
Engine 8 x 11,400 lb (5,164 kg) thrust Pratt & Whitney J57 turbojet (later, 17,000 lb (7,701 kg) thrust turbofans)
Top speed 650 mph (1,047 km/h)

Designed to carry nuclear warheads across continents, the huge B-52 has served with the USAF since 1955 (extensively in Vietnam) and is still in service. With current upgrades it is expected to serve into the 2040s.



△ **Chance Vought F8U-2 (F8K) Crusader 1960**
Origin USA
Engine 10,700-18,000 lb (4,847-8,154 kg) thrust Pratt & Whitney J57 afterburning turbojet
Top speed 1,225 mph (1,975 km/h)

First flown in 1955, this carrier-borne supersonic fighter enjoyed a long service. It was the last US fighter with guns as the primary weapon. Its wings tilted upward for takeoff and landing.



△ **Fairey Gannet AEW.3 1960**
Origin UK
Engine 3,875 hp Armstrong Siddeley Double Mamba ASDM 4 turboprop
Top speed 250 mph (402 km/h)

First flown in 1949, the Gannet was adapted in 1958 to provide an airborne early warning service from carriers, serving until 1978. It had two turbines, each driving one of the contra-rotating propellers.



△ **Dassault Mirage III 1960**
Origin France
Engine 9,436-13,668 lb (4,275-6,192 kg) thrust SNECMA Atar 9C afterburning turbojet
Top speed 1,460 mph (2,350 km/h)

Developed in the late 1950s, the delta-wing Mirage III was a successful light interceptor that, along with this stretched IIIE fighter-bomber variant, still serves with many smaller air forces.



△ **McDonnell Douglas F-4 Phantom II 1960**
Origin USA
Engine 2 x 11,905-17,844 lb (5,400-8,094 kg) thrust General Electric J79-GE-17A turbojets
Top speed 1,472 mph (2,370 km/h)

This tandem-seat fighter-bomber using titanium extensively in its airframe set outright speed and altitude records. The Phantom II was a successful combat aircraft for decades; 5,195 were built.

▷ **English Electric Lightning F6 1968**
Origin UK
Engine 2 x 14,430-16,350 lb (6,537-7,406 kg) thrust Rolls-Royce Avon 200-301R turbojets
Top speed 1,500 mph (2,400 km/h)

"Teddy" Petter's stacked-engine design was the only British-made Mach 2 fighter. The original F1 version was the RAF's first true supersonic fighter. The F6 had more thrust than the F1 and carried more fuel.

